

The First Real Deadline: The Disagreement

第一个真实期限：分歧

Theme: 求职、职场与职业发展 · New: 45 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 45/6, 127

English Story

The disagreement was about one **week**: ship on **Friday**, or wait **beyond** the **weekend** and lose the **holiday** slot. “We are **always** doing this,” Maya said. “We **spend Monday to Thursday** arguing and then hurry on **Friday**.” The **police** had asked for a signed **guideline**; the **inspector** had asked for two more days. “Certainly the **worst** option is a **dash at dawn**,” she said. “And the catch is that we have already promised.”

Lin argued for a **speedy** release. A **successful** release would be a **Christmas** present for the council; a delayed one would cost the **acquisition** and lose the **festival** coverage. “The **era** of the perfect launch is over,” he said. “The **customary** thing is to go out on **Monday** and fix it on **Tuesday**.”

Maya argued for a **durable** release. “**Wednesday** is the only **weekday** the **inspector** can come,” she said. “**Thursday** is the **marathon**; **Saturday** is the day we sleep. A **pregnancy** of nine months does not become **negotiable** because **Thanksgiving** arrives.” The **prohibitive** cost of a recall was the part he kept overlooking.

Amid the argument, the coordinator produced the **sequential** figures: the **accumulative** risk of the last three releases, measured **evenly** across the **weekend** and the **weekday**. “Two **successive** releases went out **overnight**,” she said. “The **excellence** of the first hid the failure of the second. In the **meantime**, nobody ran the test.”

The compromise was **expensive** and honest: release on **Friday** for the **festival**, and **hasten** the inspection so that the new **guideline** could be established by the following **week**. “The **usual guideline** is written for the best case,” the **inspector** said. “Write the other one.” They listened to each other for the first time that day, and the cost of the argument was one **weekend** of **running** repairs.

For the council, the cost was one more day in court; for the team, it was a new line in the guideline. “Certainly the catch is that we must go back and establish who pays,” Maya said. “If we do not listen to the other side, the help we give will be a move in the wrong direction.” They put their hearts into the last paragraph, and the **inspector**, in the end, signed it.

中文翻译

分歧关于一周中的某一天：周五发布，还是等到周末之后、丢掉假期的档期。“我们总是这样，”曼雅说，“周一到周四争论，然后周五赶工。”警方要求一份签署的指导方针；检查员要求再给两天。“最糟的选择毫无疑问是黎明时的冲刺，”她说，“而陷阱在于我们已经答应了。”

林伟主张迅速发布。一次成功的发布将是给委员会的圣诞礼物；一次延期则会损失这次收购，并错过节庆报道。“完美上线的时代已经结束了，”他说，“惯常的做法是周一发布，周二修。”

曼雅主张持久的发布。“周三是检查员唯一能来的平日，”她说，“周四为马拉松；周六是我们睡觉的日子。九个月的孕期不会因为感恩节到来就变成可磋商的。”召回那笔高昂到禁止性的成本，是他一直忽略的部分。

在争论中，协调人拿出了连续的数据：最近三次发布的累积风险，在周末与平日之间均匀地衡量。“连续两次发布都是在一夜之间上线的，”她说，“第一次的优秀掩盖了第二次的失败。与此同时，没有人跑过测试。”

妥协是昂贵而诚实的：周五为节庆发布，同时加紧检查，让新的指导方针能在下一周确立。“常规的指导方针是为最好的情况写的，”检查员说，“把另一种情况也写出来。”那天他们第一次真正听了彼此的话，而这场争论的代价，是一个周末的边跑边修。

对委员会来说，代价是多上一天法庭；对团队来说，是指导方针里多出的一行。“当然，陷阱在于我们必须回头确立由谁付钱，”曼雅说，“如果我们不听另一方的意见，我们给出的帮助就会变成方向错误的一步。”他们全心全意地写下了最后一段，而检查员最终签了字。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
week wɪ:k POS: n	n. 星期, 周 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. any period of seven consecutive days; n. a period of seven consecutive days starting on Sunday
always ˈɔ:lweɪz POS: adv	adv. 总是, 始终 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. at all times; all the time and on every occasion; r. at any time or in any event; r. forever; throughout all...
police peˈli:s POS: n	n. 警察, 警察当局, 治安; vt. 维持治安, 管辖 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the force of policemen and officers
spend spend POS: vt	vt. 花费, 浪费, 度过, 消耗, 消磨; vi. 花费, 用尽 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. pass time in a specific way; v. pay out; v. spend completely
beyond biˈjɒnd POS: prep	prep. 超过, 在那一边, 迟于; adv. 在远处; n. 更远处 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. farther along in space or time or degree; r. on the farther side from the observer; r. in addition
successful səkˈsesfəl POS: a	a. 成功的, 一帆风顺的, 顺利的; [经] 成功的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. having succeeded or being marked by a favorable outcome
holiday ˈhɒlədi POS: n	n. 假日, 假期, 节日; vi. 度假 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a day on which work is suspended by law or custom
Christmas ˈkrɪsməs POS: n	n. 圣诞节 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. period extending from Dec. 24 to Jan. 6; n. a Christian holiday celebrating the birth of Christ; a quarter...
Saturday ˈsætədi POS: n	n. 星期六 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the seventh and last day of the week; observed as the Sabbath by Jews and some Christians
weekend ˈwi:kend POS: n	n. 周末, 周末休假 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a time period usually extending from Friday night through Sunday; more loosely defined as any period of su...
usual ˈju:ʒuəl POS: a	a. 平常的, 通常的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. occurring or encountered or experienced or observed frequently or in accordance with regular practice or p...
expensive ɪkˈspensɪv POS: a	a. 贵的, 奢华的, 费用浩大的, 乱化钱的; [经] 高价的, 昂贵的, 浪费的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. high in price or charging high prices
Friday ˈfraɪdi POS: n	n. 星期五 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the sixth day of the week; the fifth working day
Monday ˈmʌndi POS: n	n. 星期一 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the second day of the week; the first working day
era ˈɪərə POS: n	n. 时代, 纪元, 时期 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a period marked by distinctive character or reckoned from a fixed point or event; n. a major division of ge...
Wednesday ˈwenzdi POS: n	n. 星期三 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the fourth day of the week; the third working day
Thursday ˈθə:zdi POS: n	n. 星期四 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the fifth day of the week; the fourth working day
inspector ɪnˈspektə POS: n	n. 检查员, 巡视员; [化] 检查员 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a high ranking police officer
Tuesday ˈtju:zdi POS: n	n. 星期二 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the third day of the week; the second working day
festival ˈfestɪvəl POS: a	a. 节日的, 喜庆的, 快乐的; n. 节日, 庆祝, 欢宴 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a day or period of time set aside for feasting and celebration; n. an organized series of acts and performa...
acquisition ˌækwɪˈzɪʃən POS: n	n. 获得, 获得物; [经] 收购, 招揽, 取得 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of contracting or assuming or acquiring possession of something; n. something acquired
guideline ˈgaɪdlaɪn POS: n	n. 指导路线, 方针, 指标; [经] 指导路线, 方针, 准则 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a light line that is used in lettering to help align the letters

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
overlook ˌəʊvə'lʊk POS: vt	vt. 俯瞰, 远眺, 没注意到; n. 眺望, 俯瞰到的景色 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a high place affording a good view; v. look past, fail to notice; v. watch over
running ˈrʌnɪŋ POS: n	n. 赛跑, 流出, 运转; a. 流动的, 跑着的, 连续的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the state of being in operation; n. the act of administering or being in charge of something; a. (of fluids)...
pregnancy ˈpregnənsi POS: n	n. 怀孕; 丰富, 多产; 意义深长 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the state of being pregnant; the period from conception to birth when a woman carries a developing fetus i...
successive sək'sesɪv POS: a	a. 继承的, 连续的; [经] 接续承运人; 连续的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s in regular succession without gaps
amid ə'mɪd POS: prep	prep. 在其间, 在其中; [经] 在...中 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: prep. See Amidst.; prep. In the midst or middle of; surrounded or encompassed by;; among.
dawn dɔ:n POS: n	n. 破晓, 黎明; vi. 破晓 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the first light of day; n. the earliest period; n. an opening time period; v. appear or develop
meantime ˈmi:ntaɪm POS: n	n. 间隔时间, 其时; adv. 其间 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n the time between one event, process, or period and another; r during the intervening time
thanksgiving ˈθæŋks.gɪvɪŋ POS: n	n. 感谢 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. fourth Thursday in November in the United States; second Monday in October in Canada; commemorates a feast...
overnight ˌəʊvənait POS: n	n. 前一天晚上, 一夜的逗留; a. 通宵的, 晚上的, 前夜的; adv. 在前一夜, 整夜, 昨晚一晚上 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. during or for the length of one night; r. happening in a short time or with great speed
evenly ˈi:vənli POS: adv	adv. 平衡地, 平坦地, 平等地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. in equal amounts or shares; in a balanced or impartial way; r. in a level and regular way
dash dæʃ POS: n	n. 冲撞, 破折号, 短跑; vi. 猛冲, 冲撞; vt. 泼溅, 使猛撞, 挽和, 使破灭, 使沮丧 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. distinctive and stylish elegance; n. a quick run; n. a footrace run at top speed; n. the longer of the two te...
excellence ˈeksələns POS: n	n. 优秀, 卓越, 优点 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the quality of excelling; possessing good qualities in high degree; n. an outstanding feature; something in...
marathon ˈmæərəθən POS: n	n. 马拉松, 耐力的考验 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. any long and arduous undertaking; n. a footrace of 26 miles 385 yards; n. a battle in 490 BC in which the At...
customary ˈkʌstəməri POS: a	a. 习惯的, 惯常的; [经] 通常的, 习惯的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. in accordance with convention or custom
speedy ˈspi:di POS: a	a. 快的, 迅速的; [经] 快的, 迅速的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s characterized by speed; moving with or capable of moving with high speed; s accomplished rapidly and without...
durable ˈdjʊərəbl POS: a	a. 持久的, 耐用的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. existing for a long time; s. capable of withstanding wear and tear and decay; s. very long lasting
weekday ˈwi:kdeɪ POS: n	n. 周日, 平日; [计] 工作日 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. any day except Sunday (and sometimes except Saturday)
hasten ˈheɪsn POS: vt	vt. 催促, 加紧; vi. 赶快, 急忙 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v act or move at high speed; v move fast; v speed up the progress of; facilitate; v cause to occur rapidly
sequential sɪ'kwɛnʃəl POS: a	a. 连续的, 后果的; [计] 顺序的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s in regular succession without gaps
worst wɜ:st POS: n	n. 最坏, 最坏的时候; a. 最坏的, 最恶劣的, 最不利的; adv. 最坏, 最糟 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the least favorable outcome; n. the greatest damage or wickedness of which one is capable; n. the weakest ef...
negotiable ni'gəʊʃiəbl POS: a	a. 可磋商的, 可转让的, 可通行的; [经] 可流通的, 可转让的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. capable of being passed or negotiated; s. able to be negotiated or arranged by compromise
prohibitive prə'hɪbɪtɪv POS: a	a. 禁止的, 禁止性的; [经] 禁止性的, 抑制的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. tending to discourage (especially of prices)
accumulative ə'kju:mjuleɪtɪv POS: a	a. 积聚而成的, 累积的; [经] 累积的, 累计的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. increasing by successive addition; s. marked by acquiring or amassing